

THE VARELA LAW OFFICE

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LEGAL REPRESENTATION CONTRACT

I, Rena Boutte, who is referred to as the "Client" occupies the legal services of **THE VARELA LAW OFFICE, PLLC**, who shall hereinafter be referred to as the "Firm" under the following clauses:

PURPOSE

By means of this contract, the Client hires the services of the Firm and specifically entrusts the management consisting of carrying out the process of:

Modification

FEES

A Retainer Fee of \$ 2,500 to secure payment of invoices retains the Firm as legal representative. This is an hourly arrangement. Hourly billing will not come out of the Retainer Fee funds. The Retainer is intended as security for payment of future invoices and at the discretion of the Firm, may be credited toward the final payment in this matter. If no Retainer funds are used, the Retainer will be refunded at the end of the representation, except for any minimum cancellation charges described below. Unused Retainer funds will be refunded at the conclusion of the case to the extent that any unused funds remain. The Retainer Fee is refundable to the extent there is an unearned Retainer balance at the end of the representation. The Retainer Fee amount requirement may be increased if the average monthly charges exceed the Retainer Fee amount.

Monthly payments will vary depending on the amount of work completed each period. At the end of the representation, at the discretion of the Firm, the Retainer Fee may be used to cover the last invoice, and any balance left will be refunded to the client.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

The Client and the Firm may agree to modify the management coverage; however, any modification must be agreed upon in writing. This agreement expressly excludes the payment of any fees or charges required by any government agency to process any application, as well as the preparation of services not specifically described under the "Purpose" paragraph of this contract.

I, the Client, understand that if I have not paid according to the payment plan described, I authorize the Firm to withhold any documents related to the case until I am current with the delinquent account and/or the Firm will not work on the next stage of the process until I am current on the payment plan. **NOTE:** I will have a maximum of ten (10) business days from the date of invoice to pay in full. If I do not, the Firm reserves the right to withdraw from representation and stop work on this matter. The Firm may request upfront payments in anticipation of significant work, such as preparation for, or representation at, mediation, a motion, a hearing, or trial. Moreover, if I do not pay my invoice in ten (10) business days from the date of the invoice, the Firm reserves the right to charge my credit card for any and all outstanding legal fees, and expenses up to Five Thousand Dollars (\$5,000).

I understand that the Firm's representation will end upon completion of the services set forth above. In addition, either the Client or the Firm may terminate this agreement at any time, with or without cause, upon notice to the other party, although the Firm's right of termination may be limited by the Standards of Professional Conduct of the State of Texas.

I understand I will be billed for all time spent on this matter. Billable Time includes but is not limited to, legal research; drafting/reading emails, letters, pleadings and documents, messages, telephone calls, communications with Client, witnesses, court staff, and other persons, mediation and settlement negotiations, pretrial preparation, fact investigation, reviewing materials, travel time, and court appearances.

In the event of termination by either party, the fees earned by the Firm shall be determined by the number of hours worked up to the time of termination and the billing rate of the person rendering the legal services. All Billable Time will be rounded up to the nearest one-tenth of an hour. Currently, the hourly rate for attorneys is \$375-\$425, paralegals \$150-\$200, and legal assistants \$100-\$150. The Firm reserves the right to modify its rates from time to time. If Client chooses not to consent to the modified rate(s), Client may elect to pay the old hourly rates and terminate the Firm's services under this agreement by written notice effective when received by the Firm. The minimum cancellation fee is \$375.

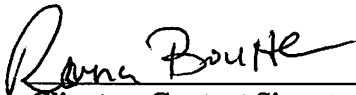
During the course of rendering services to the client, it may be necessary to incur expenses that are not strictly a fee, such as the payment required by any governmental agency for the reception and processing of an application, petition, or request ("**filing fee**"), travel and lodging expenses or additional services, which are provided by third parties, e.g., professionals or experts, couriers, interpretation and translations, administrative assistance, etc. Some of these expenses may be optional or recommended, and before retaining such services, we will seek your approval if the cost exceeds the amount of your deposit. We will bill you for expenses as, or before, they are incurred.

Client understands that Client is a client of the Firm and not of any particular attorney. Client understands that more than one attorney may be working on its case, and any attorney may be removed, assigned, or reassigned to this matter at the sole discretion of the Firm and as the Firm deems appropriate. The Firm shall keep the Client reasonably apprised of such changes.

Client responsibilities are: (a) Providing necessary information and documents in a timely manner, (b) Attending court appearances or depositions as required, (c) Paying invoices promptly, (d) Timely informing the Firm of any address or telephone changes. Failure to comply with these requirements will result in cancellation of the representation. Client's obligation to pay Fees and Costs is not contingent on the outcome of the Matter and must be paid by Client irrespective of the results obtained.

The Texas Government Code requires that the Client is notified that the State Bar of Texas investigates professional misconduct committed by Texas attorneys. Although not every complaint or dispute with an attorney involves professional misconduct, the State Bar of Texas will provide information by calling 800-932-1900.

The Client understands that the corresponding government agency or court will make the decision of the case and, therefore, the Firm cannot guarantee favorable results to the Client. The Client understands that the Firm cannot control the time that it takes the corresponding government office or court to process a request, application or procedure. The Client understands that any delay on the part of the corresponding government agency in processing an application or request will not be a reason to stop paying the fees due under this contract. All statements made by our staff are opinions only.



Client or Contact Signature & Date

Client Information

Name: Rena Boutte

Address: 3522 Brunswick Meadows
Houston, TX 77035

Telephone: 281-865-0567

Email: rena_boutte@yahoo.com

Attorney Signature & Date

Contact Information

Name: Rhonda Boutte

Address: _____

Telephone: 713-296-9990

Email: _____

Relationship to Client: Sister